Urinetown – The Musical

by Mark Hollmann and Greg Kotis

Suggested Roles: ***Actor:*** *Lockstock, Cladwell, Old Man Strong, Bobby*
Actress: *Little Sally, Fipp, Hope, Penny, Little Becky Two-Shoes, McQueen, The Poor*

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

Early morning. The poorest, filthiest urinal in town. Above the entrance to the urinal hangs a sign that reads Public Amenity #9. Officer Lockstock enters and addresses the audience directly.

LOCKSTOCK: **(Pg 9-10)** Well, hello there. And welcome to a town like any town. *(motions to sign)* As the sign says, it's a "public amenity," meaning public toilet. People have been waiting for hours to get in; it's the only amenity they can afford to get into.

LITTLE SALLY: Say, Officer Lockstock, is this where you tell the audience about the water shortage? The hard times? The drought? A shortage so awful that private toilets eventually became unthinkable?

LOCKSTOCK: Little Sally. You're too young to understand, but nothing can kill a show like too much exposition.

LITTLE SALLY: How about a bad title? That could kill a show pretty good.

LOCKSTOCK: **(Pg 11)** *(ignoring Little Sally)* These public bathrooms are controlled by a private company, the Urine Good Company. They keep admission high, so if you're down on your luck, you have to come to a place like this -- one of the poorest, filthiest urinals in town.

LITTLE SALLY: And you can't just go in the bushes either -- there's laws against it. *(counting coins in her hand)*

LOCKSTOCK: That's right. Harsh laws, too. That's why Little Sally here's counting her pennies.

LITTLE SALLY: I'm very close, Officer. **(Pg 14)** 496 . . . 497 . . . Only a few pennies away . . .

LOCKSTOCK: **(Pg 11)** Aren't we all, Little Sally. Aren't we all.

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INTRODUCTION

ACTRESS: *Welcome to Urinetown -- a place where citizens must pay to pee and anyone daring to question authority mysteriously "disappears."*
ACTOR: *Sound absurd? Maybe not. In today's America, where basic human needs like healthcare, housing, and even clean water often come with a price tag, Urinetown feels less like satire and more like a mirror.*
ACTRESS: *Beneath its ridiculous premise lies a biting truth: when greed runs the system and justice can be bought, dystopia starts to feel a lot like business as usual.*
TOGETHER: *Urinetown – The Musical by Mark Hollmann and Greg Kotis*

The executive offices of Urine Good Company. Cladwell is meeting with Senator Fipp.

FIPP: **(Pg 21)** I made my speech! Where's my dough?!

CLADWELL: Oh, there'll be plenty of dough for everyone, Senator, once the new fee hikes breeze through the Legislature.

FIPP: It's a powder keg out there, Cladwell. This time I think it's gonna blow! *(exits)*

CLADWELL: **(Pg 23)** *(to the audience)* Twenty years ago we came to the people of this community with a simple proposition: Look the other way while we run this company the way we see fit, and we will keep the pee off the street and the water in the ground. I made flushing mean "flush at the bank!" *(proud beat, the introduces Hope)* This here's my daughter Hope Cladwell. One day she may be standing in the shoes you see me wearing today, the shoes I wore when I made that promise those many years ago.

HOPE: **(Pg 24)** Gosh, I never realized large, monopolizing corporations could be such a force for good in the world. **(Pg 27)** Gosh, Daddy, why do I feel so conflicted?

CLADWELL: Nonsense. Did I send you to the Most Expensive University in the World to teach you how to feel conflicted, or to learn how to manipulate great masses of people?

*****Scene***** *Public Amenity #9*

PENNY: **(Pg 14-16)** All right, folks, you know the drill. Form a line and have yer money ready. We'll not be repeating yesterday's fiasco, and that means you, Old Man Strong.

OLD MAN STRONG: C'mon, Penny, I'm good for it.

PENNY: That's what you said last week and I still haven't seen penny one. And it's Ms. Pennywise to you.

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OLD MAN STRONG: Now, Ms. Pennywise, we've all had to make special . . . arrangements with people in high places over the years. Why not let this one be ours?

PENNY: Get your head out of the clouds! No one gets in for free.

OLD MAN STRONG: In the name of God, Penny, what difference could it make?

PENNY: The politicians in their wisdom taxed the toilets and made illegal Public urination. [And] I run the only toilet in this part of town, you see. So, if you've got to go, you've got to go through me. Water's worth its weight in gold these days. No more bathrooms like the olden days. It's a privilege to pee.

OLD MAN STRONG: **(Pg 18-20)** It's no way to live, I tells ya! No way to live! *(struggling to hold his bladder, he turns from the audience and urinates on the street)*

LITTLE BECKY TWO-SHOES: He's peein' right there on the pavement, he is!

LOCKSTOCK: *(enters blowing a police whistle, he sidesteps to avoid the large puddle)* Breaking the Public Health Act is an exiling offense, Strong.

LITTLE BECKY TWO-SHOES: *(gasps)*

OLD MAN STRONG: *(zipping up and turning back to audience)* What if it is? I feel better now, and that's all I cares about. I did what I thought was necessary! *(cuffed off by Lockstock, he yells as he is hustled away)* . . . Remember me, boys! Remember me!

PENNY: **(Pg 9)** *(shrugs without sympathy)* They carted old So-and-So off to Urinetown! *(dusts off her hands and gets back to business)* **(Pg 14)** All right, folks, you know the drill. Form a line and have yer money ready.

*****Scene*****

LITTLE SALLY: **(Pg 38)** What's it like, Officer Lockstock? Urinetown.

LOCKSTOCK: **(Pg 9)** It's kind of a mythical place. A bad place. Its power depends on mystery *(whispers)* **(Pg 38)** I can't just blurt it out, like, "There is no Urinetown! We just kill people!"

*****Scene***** *Public Amenity #9*

McQueen makes a speech to the poor.

MCQUEEN: **(Pg 39)** And so with this piece of paper the UGC awards Amenity Number Nine the first of our new and entirely legal fee hikes, which we hope you all will honor and enjoy. Of

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course, no one knows better than the good people at Urine Good Company how difficult times are, but research into finding the long-term solutions we need is expensive. So, for the time being, our decision is firm and we look forward to going to Rio with our new profits. *(Pause)* I mean, we look forward to finding lasting solutions . . . and things like that.

BOBBY: (Pg 40) *(to Penny)* I was up all night thinking about what happened to my father yesterday. About what's happening to all of us.

PENNY: He broke the law, Bobby Strong. *(to the people waiting)* All right, folks, you know the drill. We'll take your fee now. The improved fee, that is.

BOBBY: (Pg 41-42) But what if the law is wrong? What if all this is wrong?! Daily we make them pay their nickels, dimes, and quarters. And we keep filling moneybags with broken lives and dreams, but what's it for? I can't ignore these black, immoral profit-making schemes.

PENNY: The fee is the law, Bobby Strong.

BOBBY: What if there was a new law in town, Ms. Pennywise? A new law that didn't come from any voting process or elected body or process of judicial review, but a brand-new law that came from *(he thumps his chest)* a heart? *(rallying the poor, he turns and shouts)* This one's on the house for everyone! Forever! **(Pg 48)** Relieve yourself in happiness! *(crowd cheers and rushes the public amenity)*

*****Scene***** *The good offices of Urine Good Company.*

MCQUEEN: (Pg 44-45) Sorry to interrupt, Mister Cladwell. We've got a little problem. Public Amenity Number Nine, sir, The people there have rioted.

CLADWELL: Rioted?!

LOCKSTOCK: [Led by] a young man by the name of Bobby Strong.

PENNY: They're peeing for free, Caldwell. I tried to stop them.

MCQUEEN: Strictly symbolic, sir. The crowd gathered there is an unthinkably small percentage of the population as a whole.

CLADWELL: (Pg 46) People are animals! **(Pg 45)** What would you do if the very foundation of your life's work were threatened by the rabble-rousing son of a convicted criminal? We nip this unpleasantness in the bud! *(exits in a huff; others follow)*

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*******Scene******* *Public Amenity #9*

LITTLE BECKY TWO-SHOES: *(A police whistle)*Police! *(The cops enter with CLADWELL)*

BOBBY: **(Pg 49)** Wait! Wait! Please, everyone, remain calm! We've taken control of this amenity, Cladwell! The people here pee for free.

LITTLE SALLY: Officer Lockstock, what's happening?

CLADWELL: That's my amenity, Officers. I want all of these people taken away.

LITTLE SALLY: *(to Lockstock)* But what about Bobby's dreams?

LOCKSTOCK: *(to Sally)* Dreams are meant to be crushed. It's nature's way.

PENNY: **(Pg 50)** The amenity won't take much more of this uprising, Caldwell. Bobby's a sweet boy, but not sweet enough to sweeten that spillage, not by a long shot.

BOBBY: The amenity will take as much as it has to, Ms. Pennywise. The days of deprivation are over for these people.

THE POOR: Hooray!

CLADWELL: The days of deprivation have just begun if this madness continues a moment longer.

BOBBY: Sure, Mister Cladwell, that's what you've been saying for twenty years. And for twenty years we've waited for the long-term solutions that never came. Well, we're done waiting! A new day has dawned today. A day of hope and happiness when the idea of human dignity is more than just a forgotten notion, but a living, breathing reality!

HOPE: **(Pg 52)** *(rushes in to stop the mayhem)* Daddy, these people need understanding, not brutality.

CLADWELL: On the contrary, Hope dear, a little brutality is exactly what these people need. *(to Bobby)* You are wrong, Mister Strong, You and your socialistic throng! If the people pee for free, they'll push the system to the brink! You are wrong! **(Pg 55)** You've picked a fight you can't win, today, Mister Strong! Your rabble is no match for my men.

LITTLE SALLY: *(defiantly)* You can punish our bodies, Mister Cladwell, but you can never punish our spirits!

BOBBY: **(Pg 59)** *(grabs Hope as a shield)* Keep your men back, Cladwell! We've got your

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daughter and we're not letting her go!

HOPE: Help me!

BOBBY: Now run, everybody! Run for your lives! RUN!!

*****Scene*****

LOCKSTOCK: **(Pg 61)** The rebel poor under Bobby's leadership kidnapped Hope and used her as a shield to escape due punishment from my ... man. Word has it, they're holed up in some secret hideout somewhere. *(sees Little Sally hiding and nabs her)* **(Pg 65)** Where are they hiding, Little Sally?! Tell me and I'll see things go easy on you.

LITTLE SALLY: Easy on me?! You mean like sending me to the nice part of Urinetown?! Save it for one of your other stoolies, Officer Lockstock. My heart's with the rebellion. And besides, the way I see it, I'm already in Urinetown. We all are. Even you. *(to audience)* What is Urinetown? It's the town wherever people learn to live in fear. So look around -- Urinetown is your town.

*****Scene***** *In the secret hideout*

BOBBY: **(Pg 77)** I don't blame you for being angry with me, Hope. But your father gave us no choice.

HOPE: They may not have taught me much at the Most Expensive University in the World, but they taught me this much: kidnapping people is wrong.

BOBBY: I didn't mean to drag you into all this, Hope.

LITTLE BECKY TWO-SHOES: **(Pg 70-71)** String her up. That's the answer. String up the strumpet daughter of the criminal urinal chain owner Cladwell! Hang her as revenge for her father's crimes.

BOBBY: No one's going to be killing anyone around here. Friends, I know you're afraid. But this has got to be about more than just revenge. I made a promise. A promise that from this day forward, no man would be denied his essential humanity due to the condition of his pocketbook. That no man in need would be ignored by another with the means to help him.

LITTLE BECKY TWO-SHOES: All I remember him saying was "Run! Run for your lives! Run!"

BOBBY: **(Pg 75)** *(continuing)* Some of us will almost certainly not make it through the revolution

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alive! Maybe all of us! But fight on we will, for all the decades necessary, to claim freedom for the people of this land!!

******EPILOGUE*******

LOCKSTOCK: **(Pg 98)** Hope [eventually] took over her father's business, instituting a series of reforms chat opened the public bathrooms to all the people, to pee for free whenever they liked, as much as they liked, for as long as they liked. The UGC was renamed the Bobby Strong Memorial Toilet Authority and was operated as a public trust for the benefit of the public. **(Pg 99)** Of course, it wasn't long before the water turned silty, brackish, and then disappeared altogether. *As* cruel as Caldwell B. Cladwell was, his measures effectively regulated water consumption.

LITTLE SALLY: What?? The good guys finally take over and everything starts falling apart?!

LOCKSTOCK: Don't people want to be told that their way of life is unsustainable?

LITTLE SALLY: **(Pg 100)** *(sings)* This is Urinetown! This is Urinetown! *Ugh!* That title's awful!

LOCKSTOCK: Thank you. And good night!

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AWARD HISTORY

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